COUNTRY REPORTS: SUDAN

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Status report

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Sudan had no digital public infrastructure policy framework in place as at 2025, on the assessment prepared for UNDP's 2026-2028 country programme. What exists instead is an institutional map drawn in November 2025, when three bodies were created by prime-ministerial decree — the Digital Transformation Authority, the Sudanese Data and Artificial Intelligence Authority and the Sudanese Cybersecurity Authority, all under the Ministry of Digital Transformation and Communications.

The ministry's own published commitment is a 3x3 digital transformation plan setting out three pathways — citizen services, private-sector services and government-sector services — each with named projects and lead ministries. Ownership elsewhere is thinner than the announcements suggest. The Central Bank of Sudan's financial inclusion directorate has been given a mandate to formulate a national financial inclusion strategy and a consumer protection framework, which is a commission rather than a document. The finance ministry set its own priorities in August 2026 as automating payroll, invoicing, procurement and electronic collection, with no legal instrument attached to any of them.

The administrative base carrying all of this was weakening well before the war reached its present stage. Sudan scored 29.6 of 100 for overall governance in 2023, 51st of 54 African states and far below the continental average of 49.3, and its Public Administration score fell 12.0 points over 2014-2023 to 24.2 of 100, 52nd of 54 and the second-largest driver of that overall decline. It sat below the continental average on all 16 of the index's sub-categories and among the bottom ten African states on 13 of them. The central bank's strategic plan for 2026-2030 was published with 150 initiatives, its digital axis committing to a banking disaster-recovery centre, a wider data-centre network and a hybrid cloud; a banker's review of September 2026 finds no programmes, budgets or indicators attached.

Legislation and regulation

Sudan's digital statute book is still the pair of Acts passed in 2007, and the instruments meant to replace it have not moved. Three drafts prepared by the Ministry of Digital Transformation and Communications — a data and artificial intelligence law, a cybersecurity law and a digital transformation law — were before the Council of Ministers on 6 August 2026, and none had been passed. Any of them would be enacted not by an elected chamber but by the interim legislative arrangement set out in the Constitutional Document.

What is in force is narrow and old. The Electronic Transactions Act 2007 governs electronic signatures, electronic transactions and digital identification, while the Cybercrime Act of 2007, amended in 2020, is the principal cybersecurity statute and criminalises unauthorised access to and disclosure of data. Identity rests on the Civil

Registration Act 2011, which makes registration for the national identity card compulsory for citizens aged 16 and above, with enforcement varying across the country and particularly in conflict-affected areas; the card and number it issues remain the legal proof of identity required for formal employment, banking and other legal purposes.

Everything built since sits outside that statute book rather than inside it. The three digital authorities announced in November 2025 were created by prime-ministerial decree rather than by legislation, and no data-protection statute has been enacted at all: a draft data protection bill proposed around 2018 was never passed. A pharmacist was sentenced to six years over a private phone conversation opposing the war, convicted under the criminal code and the cybercrime law after intelligence officers searched his phone (August 2026).

Data protection

Sudan has never enacted a comprehensive data-protection statute. A draft data protection bill proposed around 2018 was never passed, and no independent data protection authority has been established; as at August 2026 the draft law that would govern personal data had not been passed. The Sudanese Data and Artificial Intelligence Authority created by decree in November 2025 sits inside the communications ministry and is a government data body, not a regulator holding statutory powers over the state's own collection. No regional obligation fills the gap: the African Union's Malabo Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection was signed in March 2023 and has not been ratified.

What governs personal data is a sectoral patchwork. The Electronic Transactions Act 2007 and the Cybercrime Act 2007 as amended in 2020 criminalise unauthorised access to and disclosure of data but create no obligation to notify users, a regulator or a data protection authority of a breach, and neither imposes a data-residency requirement or any enforceable control over cross-border transfers of government or personal data. Consumer protection for digital payments rests mainly on the 2013 Regulation on Electronic Fund Transfers, supplemented by the Civil Transactions Act 1984 and the Electronic Transactions Act 2007, with provisions scattered, enforcement inconsistent and no purpose-built recourse mechanism for digital payment channels. Identity decisions reach no dedicated tribunal or appeals body and are challengeable only through the ordinary courts.

That base is now carrying compulsory collection at national scale. The central bank has ordered every bank to compile and update the data held on every customer, and to suspend and freeze the accounts of those who do not — a condition imposed on licensed banks under anti-money-laundering rules, which confers no rights on the customers whose data is compelled — and the deadline was extended to the end of 2026. SudaPass, named as the means of completing it, publishes a privacy policy setting out data-subject rights of access, correction, deletion and withdrawal of consent, with no supervisory authority to enforce them against. Sudan's Digital Freedom score stood at 17.0 of 100 in 2023, 49th of 54 African states.

Regional collaboration

Sudan signed the African Union's Malabo Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection in March 2023 and has not ratified it. Its Regional Integration score rose 3.8 points over 2014-2023 to 22.0 of 100, 47th of 54 African states, across memberships of COMESA, CEN-SAD and IGAD. The national payment rails have no connectivity outside the country; the physical links run north, where a 400-km fibre cable from Egypt opened in October 2004 and the state operator agreed with the Egyptian incumbent in April 2021 to carry international traffic over it, and in August 2026 the government resolved to replace its bilateral border-trade protocols with neighbouring states with a single national framework.

Standards

Sudan's flagship platforms of 2026 were launched without a published standard between them. No architecture, standard or timetable has been published for the announced linkage between the Nazaha procurement platform, the budget execution system and the Baladna trade platform, announced on 9 August 2026, and the procurement system launched three days later was presented as bringing the country closer to international standards of governance and financial oversight rather than as implementing any named one.

The most detailed standards claim of the year is a supervisory one. A Central Bank of Sudan directive requires every bank to update its customers' account data between 30 July and 30 September 2026, after which unupdated accounts are to be suspended and frozen, on stated anti-money-laundering, counter-terrorist-financing and proliferation-financing grounds; the bank's Field Supervision Department presents the exercise as compliance with international banking-supervision standards. The same directive requires banks to deploy technology capable of continuously monitoring account activity and detecting unusual transaction patterns at an early stage, layered onto the data refresh rather than run as a separate programme, and one bank has pushed the requirement to its customers through the Bankak mobile app. The deadline was extended to the end of 2026 on 17 August 2026.

Where a published instrument does sit behind a system, it is an older one: electronic certification is governed by the 2018 regulation for certification service providers, under which the National Authority for Digital Certification runs the SudaPass platform. In public financial management, a team was formed in August 2026 to adopt reform standards, without those standards being named. Electronic collection of standards and metrology fees reached a second state in September 2026, the White Nile branch issuing an electronic receipt at the moment of payment.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Sudan's digital policy argument is being carried in newspaper columns by individual specialists rather than through any consultative mechanism. In August 2026 an economist called publicly for the Ministry of Digital Transformation, working with the central bank and key ministries, to impose comprehensive and mandatory automation across government revenue collection, customs, taxes and the gold trade, naming artisanal gold as one of the largest channels moving cash outside the banking system. In July 2026 a named specialist set out a ten-pillar digital microfinance programme for 2027-2030, built around a unified national platform connecting banks, microfinance institutions, fintechs and the payments switch, a unified digital credit registry and a new bank for microfinance and community development.

The one live public argument over a working digital system has run on financial-inclusion and anti-money-laundering terms rather than privacy ones: bankers pressed in August 2026 for flexibility in the compulsory customer-data update, arguing that it should be measured by customers retained and updated rather than by accounts closed.

Formal participation is where the country scores worst of all. Participation was its lowest-scoring governance sub-category at 10.5 of 100 in 2023, 53rd of 54 African states and down 4.8 points over the decade, with Deliberative & Participatory Governance at 19.1 and Civil Society Space at 20.0. Over the same decade Media Freedom fell 5.0 points to 27.8 of 100, 51st of 54, while Freedom of Expression & Belief rose 14.6 points to 37.9. In the war, journalists have been targeted by both sides with arrests, detentions, abductions and killings (May 2026). The register that would underpin any elected voice in policy has not been updated since 2015, through the 2019 revolution, the 2021 coup and the war that followed in 2023.

Finance

Financial sustainability

No fiscal-year budget for the digital estate had been read as at September 2026.

MoUs and other agreements

No digital cooperation agreement, vendor arrangement or bloc-level digital accord was on the record for Sudan as at August 2026.

New investments

The Sudan Family Support Project carried over US$350 million in World Bank and IDA financing (2020).

Sudan's Public Financial and Macroeconomic Management project carried US$34.8m from the African Development Bank (March 2016), delivered through the Bank's Transitional Support Facility. Online trading opened on the Khartoum Stock Exchange under it on 24 March 2016, and an integrated financial management and information system was among the complementary systems the project was developing.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Mobile connections grew through 2025: Sudan had 17.8 million by October 2025, 34.1 per cent of the population and 2.7 million more than a year earlier, alongside 14.9 million internet users at 28.7 per cent penetration, up 407,000 over the same year with the rate unchanged. Communications blackouts continued across large parts of the country through 2025.

Those figures sit on a footing better than Sudan's wider governance position would suggest. The Ibrahim Index put its Internet and Computers score at 38.9 of 100 in 2023, 19th of 54 African states after a 12.4-point rise over the decade, against an overall governance rank of 51st; mobile communications scored 68.3, 27th of 54, one of its ten best measures. The wider infrastructure sub-category scored 34.2, 32nd of 54 in 2023, and public satisfaction with infrastructure was among the country's most deteriorated measures over the same decade. GSMA measured 4G at around half the population and 3G at around seven in ten in 2022.

International capacity has never been the constraint. Four submarine systems — EASSy, FALCON, SAS-1 and SAS-2 — land at Port Sudan, and the World Bank judged first-mile connectivity sufficient, with used international bandwidth reaching 245 Gbps for a population of 42.8 million in 2019. The single exchange point, SIXP, carried four members at 1 Gbps each in August 2026, three of them valid under route-origin authorisation, with no network having joined or left in the preceding twelve months.

What the penetration figures do not show is the terms of access. By March 2026, shutdowns of land-based internet by the Sudanese Armed Forces had put the online application for humanitarian group cash transfers out of reach across much of the country, with groups in Darfur nominating one member to travel to a town Starlink terminal to file, exposing them to transit risk and to a reseller who may be aligned with a party to the conflict. Getting on the network at all requires the national identity number, since SIM registration is verified against the national ID platform, and the network itself is concentrated in Khartoum and a handful of urban centres. A binding tripartite agreement covers a fibre corridor of about 2,800 km from Djibouti's subsea landings through Ethiopia to Port Sudan, and the incumbent's group reports over 25,000 km of terrestrial fibre, with 1,586 km added in 2025. An armed group ordered satellite internet services cut off indefinitely in a West Kordofan locality from 26 August 2026.

Data Storage

Sudan's vehicle and driving-licence records survived the war because they were backed up at data centres inside the states and outside the country, the traffic police said in July 2026 — naming neither the host country nor the arrangement governing it. The one residency rule binds commercial providers, not the state: the Telecommunications and Post Regulatory Authority's data-centre and cloud regulation bars providers from storing data in the two highest levels of its data classification in cloud outside the country, and exempts government data centres, government cloud services and the public key infrastructure (2025).

Commercial hosting inside the country rests on two providers: the Sudatel data centre in Khartoum, opened in 2015, and colocation capacity from CANARTEL. There is no in-country hyperscale cloud region, so workloads are served remotely from distant regions such as Johannesburg. Both statements describe assets in a city where telecommunications data centres have been repeatedly seized and shut down since April 2023. The paramilitary forces occupied the building housing the state operator's data centres on 23 April 2023, cutting its service, and in February 2024 the largest operator's chief said they had stopped the generators at its main Khartoum data centre, cutting communications nationwide.

On the government's own estate, the Ministry of Digital Transformation said in October 2025 that the Khartoum state data centre had been brought back into service and equipped with cloud computing after war damage. What that estate has had to absorb is visible in the national payment switch, which returned to service after three years of war — restoration of damaged infrastructure rather than construction of a new rail.

Energy

Large parts of the national grid, transformers and thermal generating capacity among them, have been destroyed, stolen or left non-operational, producing frequent load shedding and in many regions no grid electricity at all, with businesses and households falling back on diesel generators at roughly twenty times the cost per kilowatt-hour of grid power (2025). That is the upstream constraint on everything else in this chapter, and a Bank of Khartoum official names power cuts alongside weak telecommunications as what holds back digital payments (July 2026).

The connection statistics belong to the period before that. About two-thirds of the population had an electricity connection in 2023, with rural connection rates running roughly thirty points behind urban ones. The Ibrahim Index recorded access to energy at 62.8 of 100 in 2023, 13th of 54 African states and up 19.0 points over the decade, one of Sudan's most improved measures of any kind. Renewable sources, principally hydropower from facilities such as the Merowe Dam, supplied the majority of electricity generated in 2021, a share that has swung widely across the decade with hydropower's output relative to thermal.

Tariffs are nominally trivial where grid power arrives — residential electricity was priced at under five US cents per kilowatt-hour in December 2025 — which is what makes the twenty-fold diesel premium the number that describes what supply actually costs.

Off-grid is the part of the sector with a framework behind it. The World Bank and ESMAP scored Sudan's regulatory arrangements at 61 of 100 for mini-grids and 56 for off-grid systems in 2025. UNDP supports a solar mini-grid programme aimed at drawing in private operators, alongside an off-grid solar market driven mainly by agricultural demand where providers are experimenting with leasing and pay-as-you-go financing, constrained but not halted by the conflict (2025).

Technical Capacity

Sudan's developer base numbers in the low thousands: committers.top recorded 2,180 GitHub users giving Sudan as their location in 2024, fed by universities with dedicated computer science and IT faculties, several of them in Khartoum. The identity estate runs on a mix of domestic and foreign capacity — the civil registry is managed by the General Directorate of Civil Registration, the Cybersecurity Authority says SudaPass is developed and operated by Sudanese professionals, and the National Authority for Digital Certification holds a partnership with the international certificate authority Sectigo for globally trusted certificates (2026).

How much an agency can absorb shows in what it counts as progress: the National Investment Authority described building its own website as a crucial step towards an electronic single window (August 2026). Where capacity held, it held offshore: the meteorological authority, its premises inaccessible since April 2023, runs from Port Sudan, Cairo and Nairobi on cloud-hosted infrastructure supported by the World Meteorological Organization, and issued a flood warning from exile (2025).

Cybersecurity

Assurance over the national digital identity platform rests on the word of its own regulator: the Cybersecurity Authority states that SudaPass undergoes regular security review and testing, with encryption key management and digital certificates administered by the National Authority for Digital Certification under approved controls (May 2026), and no independent audit of the platform is on the public record. Sudan sat in the establishing tier of the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index in 2024.

The institutions meant to carry this work are new: a digital transformation authority, a data and artificial intelligence authority and a cybersecurity authority were created by prime-ministerial decree in November 2025 under the Ministry of Digital Transformation and Communications. What they defend, they defend without a duty to disclose failure: no breach-notification obligation falls on payment service providers or any other data controller.

DPI

Data Exchange

One government-to-government link has been completed and named: Sudan's Customs Authority finished a real-time integration of its ASYCUDA system with the Civil Registry in October 2025, allowing national identity numbers to be checked directly, and it was delivered through the government's Baladna platform.

Baladna is the layer the rest of the state's integration work is being hung on. It offers services from several ministries in one place — company registration, business-name registration and licensing drawing on the Ministry of Justice, the Ministry of Local Governance, the Ministry of Industry and Trade and the Commercial Registrar, with an exports and imports window reaching customs and banking systems — and on 5 August 2026 a meeting chaired by the finance minister adopted it as the national channel for all export and import procedures, permits and authorisations. Older machinery runs alongside it: the Commercial Registrar is required to notify the Tax Chamber monthly of company registrations, amendments and deregistrations, and the Tax Authority has an integration project under way connecting its core system to other government and financial bodies including Customs, the Civil Registry, the Commercial Registrar and the Central Bank of Sudan (2025).

Most of what has been announced is not yet carrying traffic. The National Investment Authority says its electronic single window will operate only once all investment-related entities are linked electronically, and has named no entities, no sequence and no date (August 2026); on 11 August 2026 the National Economic Management

Committee directed the finance ministry and the central bank to expedite completion of the central bank's electronic application system. No architecture, standard or timetable has been published for the announced linkage between the Nazaha procurement platform, the budget execution system and Baladna.

Five separate government digital platforms — an investment single window, the Baladna foreign-trade platform, the Nazaha procurement system, the central bank's electronic application system and an agricultural-financing platform — were announced, adopted or escalated by five different ministries or authorities between 4 and 11 August 2026, and the only stated link between any two of them is Nazaha's claim to connect to Baladna.

Two sectors sit outside the layer entirely. No health data reaches a national exchange, and the one hospital information system on the record, SudaHealth, runs at state level in Khartoum (2026). Humanitarian cash is coordinated through the multi-partner Sudan Cash Working Group outside government systems, with the Humanitarian Aid Commission's presence on Baladna confined to registering and permitting aid agencies (2025). Underneath all of it, no primary law establishes authority for cross-government data sharing and no digital public infrastructure policy framework is in place (2025). The central bank launched an electronic capital-flows system replacing manual processing (August 2026), and the investment authority opened a service for investors to submit and track project requirement lists through its electronic one-stop platform.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Sudan launched SUDAPASS, a unified national digital identity credential, on 21 May 2026, and it is activated with a passport or national number together with face biometrics — so the credential is free to anyone the paper system has already documented, and unavailable to anyone it has not. It was built with the Civil Registry under the Ministry of Interior and is operated by the National Authority for Digital Certification, and sits under the Baladna programme, implemented jointly by the cybersecurity, e-certification and civil registry bodies.

What the credential gives access to is so far mostly stated rather than shown. It is designed to give holders e-services, e-transactions and digital signatures, and the Central Bank of Sudan has named it as the tool meant to ease the compulsory update of bank customer data — an announcement that gave no integration detail and no uptake figure for the credential (August 2026). Omdurman National Bank became the first bank to switch the link on, letting customers inside and outside the country update their data through its digital channels without a branch visit, with the other banks to follow one at a time (September 2026). Its legal footing is the Electronic Transactions Act 2007 and the 2018 certification regulation. SudaPass publishes a privacy policy covering the personal and biometric data it collects, its use, and rights of access, correction, deletion and withdrawal of consent, with no equivalent published framework for the civil registry beneath it.

That registry is the constraint. Established as a centralised electronic biometric system under the Civil Registration Act 2011 — identity card mandatory at 16, a child applying in person from the age of 12, records held digitally against a unique national number — it is now only partially working: Khartoum's civil registry has ceased almost entirely, and across vast areas of Sudan no entity can issue identity papers. Sudan's civil registration score fell 50 points over 2014–2023 to 25.0 of 100, 50th of 54 African states, the largest ten-year decline on any of the index's Sudan indicators; birth registration still starts on paper and coverage in Darfur and other peripheries is markedly below the cities, with around two-thirds of under-fives registered at the last national survey (2014).

The register and the national number are for citizens, who must prove nationality directly or through witnessed lineage; refugees and other non-citizens are recorded instead under a separate Foreign Number system run by the Commission for Refugees with UNHCR, which the Commission said in 2026 it is reactivating. The national number is

required to open a bank account and for know-your-customer checks, and SIM registration requires the national identity card or number; on the app through which humanitarian cash is paid, a national ID and a smart device are the account-opening requirement and therefore the point of exclusion (March 2026).

Digital Payments and Fintech

The Central Bank of Sudan launched the services of the national payment switch on 6 August 2026 with one institution connected — Omdurman National Bank — marked by a first successful ATM withdrawal over it. The switch is operated by Electronic Banking Services, the central bank's operational arm; it returned to service after three years of war, and the plan to connect all operating banks in turn carries no schedule, no ordering and no coverage target. Separately, the central bank opened a public tender in April 2026 for a National Instant Payments System.

What carries the money is one bank's app. Bank of Khartoum's Bankak had around 7 million users in February 2024, with activations up 85 per cent since the war began. Bank apps became the dominant settlement method in the capital's retail markets under currency depreciation, inflation and cash scarcity rather than through any appetite for the technology, and the channel shows it: traders without smartphones route their takings through colleagues' accounts, outages and peak-hour collapse are routine, and unfamiliarity with the apps produces mistaken transfers (July 2026). Both sides in the war have used banking-app bans as an instrument of economic warfare. The app supports transfers between a customer's own accounts, other banks and mobile-money wallets and merchant payments by QR code, and humanitarian group cash is paid through it into the personal accounts of nominated group members, because informal community groups cannot hold an institutional account (March 2026).

Government payment runs well below what it once did. The Sudan Family Support Programme paid monthly digital transfers to 8.7 million people before its suspension after October 2021, and nothing since operates at that scale. On collection, customs duties have been taken electronically since at least 2025 and, since April 2026, the finance ministry's My Payment service lets individuals pay some government dues through banking apps and authorised service points, covering particular revenue streams rather than the range of taxes, fees and charges.

The central bank owns and directly operates the real-time gross settlement system as well as overseeing it, and licenses and supervises the mobile money operators; the settlement system's business operating rules are published and downloadable without registration. Consumer protection rests on scattered instruments with no purpose-built recourse for digital payment channels, and the central bank has upgraded its financial inclusion directorate with a mandate to formulate a national strategy and a consumer protection framework (2026) — a mandate to write them rather than the documents themselves. The sharpest live question is the order that every bank update its customers' data or have the account suspended and frozen, which also requires banks to deploy continuous transaction monitoring, is being done in branch in a country of ten million displaced people, and was extended to the end of 2026 on 17 August 2026; Bank of Khartoum pushed it to users inside the Bankak app in the week it was issued. Against a base where 15 per cent of adults were banked and 11 per cent of adults used mobile money and 2 per cent were formally registered users in 2021, and where no accessibility accommodations have been identified in digital payment systems, the update campaign runs through the one rail people have. The central bank revoked the licence of a mobile-payment company, Sudan Pay Digital, in September 2026 without stating a reason. Outages of the dominant mobile payment application continued into September 2026, pushing traders back to cash, and up to 45 per cent of humanitarian transfers were reported lost converting application balances into cash in East Darfur. The finance ministry signed a framework with 11 companies to supply portable electronic collection devices to state institutions, and a second operator signed a text-message services agreement for the state collection system in October 2026. A bank launched a USSD banking service with a mobile operator, needing neither internet nor a smartphone and aimed at humanitarian payments (2026).

The finance ministry signed a contract with Sudani on 8 October 2026 for text-message services supporting the system, the third such agreement with a mobile operator.

Disruptions in the days before 9 October 2026 again left the application's customers unable to reach or transfer their money, amid cash and fuel shortages; the bank apologised.

The bank launched a USSD transfer service on one mobile operator's SIMs, reported 10 October 2026, so customers can transact without a smartphone or internet. The finance ministry said in August 2026 it was finalising an electronic payment link with Saudi mobile-banking applications to bring diaspora remittances into regulated channels, with no launch date given.

Registries

Sudan's electoral roll has not been updated since 2015, when 13,126,989 voters were registered against a voting-age population of 19,667,400 — through the 2019 revolution, the 2021 coup and the war since. It was incomplete when it was frozen: the African Union's pre-election assessment recorded roughly 2.6 million internally displaced people in Darfur left off the roll, parts of which were carried over unverified from the pre-secession 2010 register.

The population register is the one with reach. Officials put registration at close to nine in ten of the population in 2021, with markedly lower rates among peripheral and displaced populations, and the registry's director counted 37,938,429 citizens on it in December 2022, the last count before the war. It, the civil register and the identity system now work only in part: across vast areas of Sudan no entity can issue identity papers.

The economic registers are further back. Core company registration remains largely on paper, the underlying company records were destroyed in the 2023 conflict and are being rebuilt, and the Commercial Registrar is being connected to Baladna (2025). The Tax Chamber, by contrast, runs a single taxpayer registration and identification-number system spanning individuals and businesses, issuing one identification number for every tax including customs duties (2026). Land is partially digitised at best: property records in Khartoum were computerised or scanned and shared a common parcel identifier with the cadastral mapping database as two separate linked systems, office capacity varied sharply between states, and rural areas largely lacked formal registers (2019); in Darfur, around one per cent of customary land is formally registered.

One register claims to have come through the war whole. The traffic police say the national vehicle database was restored, holding more than two million registered vehicles and over three million driving licences (July 2026), attributing survival to backups at data centres inside the states and outside the country, and are introducing Ansab, a laser-secured vehicle-ownership-transfer platform intended to counter forgery. Social protection has no comparable base: the poverty registry behind the safety-net system reached six of eighteen states before 2023 and recorded beneficiaries' national identity numbers only partially. Company commercial registration was added to the national e-government platform, reported 1 October 2026.

A survivors' fund opened a tender for a secure, offline-capable digital victims' registry, built with a national organisation in an 18-month project from 1 November 2026, with about 500 survivors to be documented first and hosting outside the country.

Sectoral management information systems

Sudan's finance minister set the ministry's priorities on 4 August 2026 as payroll automation, electronic invoicing, tax-base expansion, a digital procurement platform and stronger electronic payment and collection systems, with payroll digitalisation described as being completed in cooperation with other ministries and electronic invoicing as being introduced in the tax sector.

That list restates a programme financed a decade earlier: payroll automation and an integrated procurement system are presented as new intentions in August 2026, while an IFMIS was already in scope of an African Development Bank-financed project reported in March 2016.

Health information barely reaches the point of care. Government clinics and hospitals had no electronic medical record in March 2021 and depended wholly on paper records, on a university thesis's account. Above facility level the national DHIS2 aggregate reporting system has recovered: the Federal Ministry of Health, declaring 2026 the year of full digital transformation, put routine reporting coverage at over 56 per cent by the end of 2025, against 13 per cent at the onset of the crisis, and called for expansion to link every facility — the ministry's own figures, and no independent measurement is published against them. On the Darfur disease-surveillance pilot, 158 health facilities submitted 752 weekly reports offline through a mobile tool between September 2024 and January 2025.

Education is at a similar level. The sector has a long-standing gap in up-to-date and consolidated education data, and a UNESCO-led assessment reviewed the available data only up to 2022; a strengthening initiative under the Transitional Education Plan 2025–2027, including digital mapping of around 26,000 schools, remains at planning, mapping and pilot stage and has not put digital capture into rural schools. Social protection delivery rests on a safety-net management information system built with World Bank support — poverty registry, targeting and eligibility, grievance redress, payment and monitoring modules — deployed in six of Sudan's eighteen states before the 2023 conflict, since when assistance delivery has fragmented across conflict-affected regions.

The revenue side is where the working systems are. Customs runs ASYCUDA, now checking identity numbers against the civil registry, and the Tax Authority's integration project reaches Customs, the Civil Registry, the Commercial Registrar and the central bank (2025). It is building from a low floor: Sudan's tax and revenue mobilisation score fell 16.8 points over 2014–2023 to 11.4 of 100, 52nd of 54 African states, and budgetary and financial management fell 13.9 points to 33.3, 48th. A civil-service platform, Bayan, is launched and built to integrate with digital identity, e-signature and the finance ministry's payroll platform, with no coverage figure disclosed; the zakat chamber signed a contract to complete an integrated resource-planning system stopped during the war; and the telecoms regulator convened a workshop with the ITU to approve a national emergency telecommunications plan using cell broadcast.

Court systems start from a project a decade old. The judiciary began a first phase of a judicial e-portal and court computerisation in March 2016, costed at USD 600,000, with electronic fee payment and petition tracking, and its contractor reported that phase finished and a phase covering the whole judiciary about to start in December 2016. Nothing later on that system is held; the judiciary signed a new contract with a national technology company for several digital systems in August 2026.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Sudan launched Nazaha, a national digital public-procurement and contracting system, on 12 August 2026, announced with no coverage figure, no mandatory-use rule for government entities and no contract-value threshold. It is presented as part of a wider public-finance reform programme covering budget reform and a single treasury account, and three days before the launch the prime minister reviewed the same list — an e-tendering platform, payroll computerisation, international accounting standards and a treasury single account — against the IMF's HIPC debt-relief roadmap, which is the clearest account on record of why it recurs.

The citizen-facing estate is Baladna, which added 28 services by February 2026 as the Ministry of Digital Transformation rolled it out. The platform lists 23 government institutions running on it, among them passports and immigration, higher education, the civil registry, customs, the tax chamber and the central bank, with no basic-education body among them; driving licence renewal runs through the traffic police's Salem platform and Baladna,

authenticated against the national identity number. Businesses fare better than citizens: the Tax Chamber's e-portal lets taxpayers register remotely, obtain an identification number, file and amend returns, view account activity and request clearance certificates, with the electronic payment channel still being activated state by state. A unified government employment platform for jobseekers is in final preparation for launch (2026), and a comprehensive electronic oversight system for public bodies and government companies is described as nearing completion.

Volumes, where any are given, are small. The Salem renewal service for citizens abroad now runs through embassies in 16 countries, up from six, and has issued 1,519 licences (July 2026).

Those 1,519 licences amount to roughly 0.05 per cent of the 3,161,599 driving licences on the national register (July 2026).

The measured position is early. Sudan scored 0.2759 on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024, below the African average, its effective administration score fell 5.8 points over 2014–2023 to 21.5 of 100, 51st of 54 African states, and a study of 18 local government websites found e-government at an early stage with no integration between institutions. Coordination sits with the Ministry of Digital Transformation and Communications and the three authorities created by prime-ministerial decree in November 2025, but individual bodies still start from their own foundations: the National Investment Authority describes building its own website as a crucial step towards its electronic single window. A national budget system covering estimates, execution and analysis is said to be in its final stages, planned for introduction in the 2027 budget and full operation in 2028. Public service complexes at Omdurman and Bahri have reopened, with cash abolished at the counters through seven partner banks, students now apply and pay online for the school certificate, and a platform for public-sector companies to report to the finance ministry was launched in August 2026.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Sub-national digital government in Sudan is a website presence and little else: local government sites were at an early stage in 2024, with no integration or interoperability between institutions, and the conflict has further cut sub-national digital capacity. The administrative tier below the centre is not uniform territory. Khartoum's civil registry has ceased almost entirely, local government offices and land registries have been looted or turned into barracks, and across vast areas no entity can issue identity papers, so the registers on which a locality office would depend do not exist across much of the country. The national information centre's structure includes a general directorate charged with coordinating ICT projects and training at state level. Khartoum State put its standard systems back into operation, connected a government fibre network to 36 state units and signed six partnership memoranda (2026).

Rural digital data capture

Sudan's strongest governance score is a rural one: Rural Market Access stood at 78.7 of 100 in 2023, eighth of 54 African states and up 28.3 points over the decade, the highest-scoring and most improved of the 96 indicators the Ibrahim Index measures, carrying Rural Economy to 56.6 and 31st place. The same reading has Rural Representation & Participation up 15.6 points to 63.2 and Rural Land & Water Access down 9.5 points to 29.8, 41st of 54.

None of that rural activity generates a digital record where it happens. Government clinics depended wholly on paper records, with no electronic medical record (2021); education planning faces a long-standing gap in up-to-date and consolidated sector data (2025). A digital step that reaches the facility is Darfur's mobile disease surveillance pilot, on which 158 health facilities submitted weekly reports offline (2025). The civil registry is the exception — fingerprints and photograph taken electronically, with more than a thousand mobile registration units dispatched for

the 2011 mass registration, though a birth outside hospital is registered only when parents take the midwife's notification to the nearest registry office (2023). Land is barely captured at all: formal registration reaching a very small fraction of customary land in Darfur and rural areas largely without formal registers (2019).

Connectivity and power set the ceiling. Digital infrastructure is concentrated in Khartoum and a handful of urban centres; the roughly 63 per cent of the population in rural areas has markedly weaker and poorly maintained mobile coverage, and the war has destroyed telecommunications infrastructure, caused prolonged blackouts in Khartoum and Wad Madani, and left large areas of Darfur and Kordofan with minimal or no connectivity, dependent on costly satellite alternatives such as Starlink (2025). The off-grid solar market that is growing runs mainly on agricultural demand (2025), and an agricultural-financing platform built by the Agricultural Bank with the ministries of agriculture and digital transformation had been announced but not launched as at 10 August 2026.

A stolen-vehicle lookup was added to the platform in September 2024. The police counted 80,902 citizen reports since June 2023, 59,115 of them for missing vehicles, at January 2025.

Technology

AI

Sudan has a national authority for artificial intelligence and no artificial intelligence running in government. Artificial intelligence is not in use in the state's data exchange (2025), and the data and artificial intelligence authority created by prime-ministerial decree in November 2025, sitting under the Ministry of Digital Transformation and Communications, carries a mandate to plan such capability rather than a system that runs. No national artificial intelligence strategy had been adopted as at August 2026.

Nor is there a statute. The instrument that would govern the field — a combined draft law pairing data and artificial intelligence in one text — was not advanced when ministers considered it in August 2026. What exists in the meantime is closer to a prospectus than an installation: the state data centre in Khartoum was returned to service in October 2025 with cloud and artificial-intelligence support systems, and the infrastructure and transport ministry has put artificial intelligence and transport-management technology to investors as part of post-war reconstruction (July 2026). Neither is a deployed service, and none is offered to citizens.

Outside government the groundwork is language data: a 2025 shared task produced the first public multimodal dataset for Sudanese Arabic, 3,042 captioned images and videos, and researchers at the Sudan University of Science and Technology documented a social-media corpus of 6,755,955 sentences with sentiment and hate-speech resources (2026).

ICT Industry

Sudan's business and labour environment scored 27.2 of 100 in 2023, 51st of 54 African countries, after a decade in which it fell 1.9 points; business and competition regulations, the component that most directly shapes whether a technology company can be formed and can trade, stood at 33.3 and 49th, while economic diversification at 61.7 and 32nd was the one part of the picture to gain ground over the decade, up 10.3 points.

That is the ground a domestic technology sector has to stand on, and what stands on it is mostly people rather than firms: the country's software developer community is small but active (2024), and no comparable count exists of the companies employing it. The size of the domestic software and services industry, the employment it generates and the share of government technology spending that reaches local suppliers all remain unmeasured as at August 2026.

Innovation ecosystem

Sudan's technology sector has reverted to an early stage since fighting began in April 2023, sustained largely by donor grants rather than by institutional venture capital (2024). The country sits in the bottom quartile of the Global Innovation Index 2024, with one identified science and technology cluster, and the hub layer that would normally sit between grant money and a company runs to a single organisation, Impact Hub Khartoum (2024). A social enterprise running a hub launched a 500-place youth entrepreneurship programme in Kassala under a memorandum with the state ministry, and an African Development Bank and IGAD project of about USD 3.255 million is delivered through the University of Khartoum's incubator (2026).

Capacity

Literacy

Sudan gets its children to the end of school and teaches them very little there: over the decade to 2023 its Education Quality score fell 9.1 points to 13.2 of 100, 49th of 54 African states, while over the same years its Education Completion score rose by that same 9.1 points to 70.4, ninth on the continent and one of the country's four strongest measures. The Education sub-category as a whole barely moved, at 35.7 and 47th.

Digital literacy has not been measured at all. The World Bank's 2022 assessment of Sudan's digital economy found no such data and could record the level only as perceived to be low. It matters directly to what the country is now asking of its citizens: bankers and economists reading the rush onto banking apps that the cash shortage forced name low digital awareness alongside weak telecoms and power cuts as what holds the shift back (July 2026).

The education system's own records show the same split between the top and the bottom of the ladder: the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research is one of the 23 institutions running on the Baldna platform, and no basic-education body is among them (2026).

Training and skills

The tertiary ICT pipeline is real and it is narrow. A small group of long-established universities carry computer science and IT faculties teaching at bachelor's, master's and doctoral level (2024), and that route is the main one into the profession. Behind it, no measure of the teaching workforce that would supply it was reported for Sudan at all across the decade to 2023. The higher education council approved a regulation in 2026 giving e-learning and blended learning in higher-education institutions a formal legal basis.

Research institutions

Sudan registers on the world map of research at exactly one point: the World Intellectual Property Organization's 2024 ranking of leading global science and technology clusters identifies a single cluster in the country. The institutional base under it is the same handful of universities that does the teaching — Sudan University of Science and Technology, Al Neelain University, the National University of Sudan and Future University all hold computer science and IT faculties (2024). Research capacity and teaching capacity in Sudan are housed in the same buildings.

Inclusion

Access to services

Sudanese bank customers must appear in person to keep their accounts: Bankak users were prompted in the app to update their information at the nearest Bank of Khartoum branch (August 2026), on pain of suspension. The deadline has since moved to year-end, postponing the freezes rather than the obstacle, and bankers have warned that freezing accounts on this basis risks mass financial exclusion given displacement, lost documents and disrupted branches.

The national digital credential is free, but activating it requires a passport or national identity number already held, so it reaches nobody the paper system has not; the register and the national number are restricted to citizens, non-citizens going to a separate Foreign Number system being reactivated in 2026. Whether a refugee could open an account or register a SIM turned on the provider's acceptance of the Commission of Refugees card, leaving many dependent on SIM cards registered in others' names (2022).

The Persons with Disabilities Act 2017 provides a legal basis consistent with the UN Convention, yet no accessibility accommodation — screen readers, voice interfaces, accessible agents or ATMs — has been identified in Sudan's digital payment systems, while hardship limits phone ownership and under-registration of disabled children's births compounds their exclusion (2025).

Outside the capital the service often cannot be reached: army shutdowns of land-based internet have put the online application for humanitarian group cash beyond much of the country, groups in Darfur sending one member to a town's Starlink terminal to file (March 2026). Social protection has not run at national scale since the Sudan Family Support Programme's digital transfers were suspended after October 2021; what remains is chiefly humanitarian, paid into nominated members' personal accounts because informal groups cannot hold their own.

Equality of access itself had been improving: Sudan's Equal Access to Public Services score rose 25.9 points over 2014-2023 to 36.3 of 100, 31st of 54 African states and its second most improved indicator (2023), measuring the decade to 2023, and distribution rather than level. As at 2013 the national identity card was accepted but not required for public healthcare.

Universal service has no money behind it: the Universal Service Fund, re-established under the 2018 telecommunications act, received no government support in 2024.

Digital divides

The sharpest line of exclusion in Sudan now runs along the front line rather than along any demographic axis: large areas of Darfur and Kordofan have been left with minimal or no connectivity as the war destroyed telecommunications infrastructure and blacked out cities including Wad Madani and Khartoum, and mobile connections still covered only 34.1 per cent of the population in October 2025. What survives is concentrated in Khartoum and a handful of other urban centres, leaving the rural majority on weaker coverage, unreliable maintenance and, where anything reaches them at all, costly satellite alternatives. The urban-rural line here is not a gradient of service quality; in much of the country it is the difference between a network and none.

Against that, the country's measured equality of opportunity had been improving for a decade: Sudan's Equal Socioeconomic Opportunity score rose 21.7 points over 2014-2023 to 39.2 of 100, 36th of 54 African states (2023). That series ends in 2023 and measures the decade to it, not what has happened since.

The gates that now decide who transacts are a national identity document and a smartphone, both required to open the Bankak account through which humanitarian cash is paid — so exclusion is built into the channel rather than met at its edge, and the undocumented are cut out at the point of registration rather than the point of payment. In the capital's markets bank apps have become the dominant way retail trade settles, taken up by broad segments that until recently dealt only in cash, under the pressure of currency depreciation and cash scarcity rather than any appetite for the technology; traders without a smartphone route their takings through a colleague's account in order to trade at all, and unfamiliarity with the apps produces mistaken transfers that confuse trader and customer alike. Adoption arrived at under those conditions measures what has failed, not who has been included.

Data

National statistics

Sudan has run neither an agricultural census nor a business census in the past twenty years, leaving the state without a periodic count of its farms or its firms; a population census does fall inside that window, and three or more health surveys, two agricultural surveys, two labour surveys and one household survey were run in the ten years to 2023, but no business survey at all.

The World Bank's five statistical performance pillars put data use, data sources and data infrastructure in the 20-49 per cent band in 2023 — the weakest parts of the system — against statistical services and statistical products in the 50-69 per cent band. The pattern is of an office that can still produce and publish, on a base of collection that is thinning underneath it.

On the Ibrahim Index, Capacity of the Statistical System stood at 31.2 of 100 in 2023, 48th of 54 African states, a ranking that held even after a 6.1-point rise across the preceding decade. On the index's Human Resources in Education indicator, no data existed for Sudan at all.

Administrative records do not close the gap that surveys leave. The education management information system exchanges almost no data digitally with individual schools, which compile attendance, enrolment and grades on paper, and there is no systematic measurement of digital literacy of any kind. The Central Bureau of Statistics was nonetheless still producing monthly inflation figures in June 2026, three years into the war.

Open data

Sudan's Accountability & Transparency score fell 7.5 points over the decade to 2023, to 14.5 of 100 and 49th of 54 African states, with disclosure of public records at 7.5 (52nd) and accessibility of public records at 10.7 (46th) — the question of whether official information can be obtained at all, answered worse at the end of the decade than at the start.

Individual documents do reach the public without gatekeeping. The business operating rules for the real-time gross settlement system are downloadable from the central bank without registration or a request process, and SudaPass publishes a privacy policy setting out the categories of personal and biometric data it collects and the rights attached to them. Disclosure about the government's own platform rollout has come through recurring ministry press conferences since late 2025, at the ministry's own timing and in its own terms.

Use of satellite data

No national space or geospatial agency, ground receiving station or geospatial data policy was on the record for Sudan as at August 2026.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

No American-financed digital infrastructure, no hyperscaler cloud region or government system running on a US platform, and no bilateral digital agreement with the United States were on the record for Sudan as at August 2026.

China activities

No Chinese-financed digital infrastructure, network-equipment supply to a Sudanese operator, government system running on a Chinese platform, or bilateral digital cooperation agreement with China was on the record for Sudan as at August 2026. China's foreign ministry records the digital transformation and communications minister attending the opening of a digital cooperation centre with China; no agreement text or financing is held.

EU activities

No European digital financing commitment, data-protection adequacy arrangement or European-funded connectivity project was on the record for Sudan as at August 2026.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf-owned data centre, Gulf operator holding in a Sudanese network and no Emirati or Saudi digital financing commitment were on the record for Sudan as at August 2026.

India activities

No India Stack-derived deployment in identity, payments or data exchange, and no Indian digital cooperation agreement or training programme, were on the record for Sudan as at August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Sudan's cloud rules keep the most sensitive data at home and leave the state's own estate outside them: the Telecommunications and Post Regulatory Authority's 2025 data-centre and cloud regulation bars providers, foreign ones with an agent or contract in Sudan included, from storing data in the two highest levels of its data classification in cloud outside the country, allows the second level abroad where necessary only with the approval of the requesting body's head and the regulators, and exempts government data centres, government cloud services and the public key infrastructure (2025). Internet-application licensees must declare whether their servers are hosted inside or outside Sudan and name the hosting company (August 2026).

The identity layer is held at home on the state's own account: SudaPass stores its data in government-operated data centres in Sudan, a commitment its terms repeat for primary data, and the Cybersecurity Authority says the platform is developed and operated by Sudanese professionals, with keys managed by the National Authority for Digital Certification (May 2026). Trust beyond the border is borrowed: the national root certificate is not included in browsers, so .gov.sd websites are secured through a partnership with Sectigo.

The central bank has made itself the gate on who connects to the payment system: from 3 July 2026 no licensed bank, fintech or switch operator may enter a contractual, operational or technical relationship, or exchange data, without its prior approval, and it revoked the payment-system licence of Al-Asjad Digital and Smart Solutions after a technical and legal review (July 2026).

The government's own hosting is being rebuilt as a sovereignty project: the communications minister called an alternative national data centre, under discussion with Red Sea State, the largest current investment in the country's technical infrastructure, meant to restore sovereign national infrastructure and secure all government data (March

2026). The traffic police keep backups of the national vehicle and driving-licence database at data centres outside the country (July 2026); where that backup is hosted, and under whose jurisdiction, had not been published as at September 2026.

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